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PREMIUM TECHNICAL EDITION

INFOR LN · ERPLN TECHNICAL · DEVELOPER SERIES

Creating *Tables*

in Infor LN — A Step-by-Step Technical Guide

A comprehensive technical reference for creating, defining, and deploying custom database tables in the Infor LN (ERPLN) environment. Covers table definitions, field configuration, index design, runtime data dictionary conversion, and final table creation.

Table Definitions · Fields · Labels · Indexes · Runtime Data Dictionary · Logout & Login · Create Table

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OVERVIEW

About This Guide

Prerequisites, audience, and the complete 5-step creation workflow

> *This guide walks you through the complete procedure for creating custom tables in ERPLN — from navigating to Table Definitions all the way through to verifying the created table in the General Table Display.*

No deep expertise in Baan ERP is required, though familiarity with the package/module/session structure, general business procedures, and basic ERP concepts will help you get the most from this document. For detailed session descriptions, refer to Baan ERP's comprehensive online Help.

The 5-Step Creation Workflow

1. **Create Table Definitions**
   Define the table's metadata — package, module, table number, description, and structural attributes. This is the entry point for all table creation in LN.

2. **Define Fields, Labels & Indexes**
   Add every field the table needs, configure domain bindings, labels, referential integrity rules, and create primary and secondary indexes.

3. **Convert to Runtime Data Dictionary**
   Publish the application-level metadata to the OS file system so the LN runtime can read it.
   `ttadv5215m000`

4. **Logout and Re-login**
   A fresh session is required so the runtime picks up the newly converted dictionary objects before the physical table can be created.

5. **Create Table in the Database**
   Run the Create Tables session to physically create the table for the target company and package combination.
   `ttaad4230m000`

CHAPTER ONE

Navigation & Table Definitions

Locating the Table Definitions session and registering the table in LN

> *The Table Definitions session is the foundation of every custom table in LN. Before a single field or index can be created, the table's metadata envelope must be established here.*

Navigation Path

To reach the Table Definitions session, follow this path in the LN menu tree:

```
Tools › Application Development › Domains and Tables › Table Definitions
```

Table Definition Fields

When opening a new Table Definition record, complete the following core fields:

FIELD	DESCRIPTION	NOTES
`Package`	The top-level package this table belongs to (e.g., *td*)	Determines namespace
`Module`	The sub-module within the package (e.g., *pur*)	Groups related tables
`Table No.`	Unique numeric identifier within the module	Use custom ranges (900+)
`Description`	Human-readable name shown in sessions and reports	Keep concise but clear
`VRC`	Version/Release/Customisation identifier (e.g., B61U · a · trdv)	Auto-populated
`Expired`	Marks the definition as obsolete — prevents end-user access	Use when deprecating

Attaching Documentation

Use the *Tech. Documentation* and *Release Notes* checkboxes to attach supporting documents directly to the Table Definition record — invaluable for tracking design decisions and change history across upgrades.

CHAPTER TWO

Fields, Labels & Indexes

Configuring every attribute that shapes how data lives in your table

> *Every field added to a table definition shapes how LN stores, validates, and displays that data. Getting field attributes right here prevents costly schema redesign later.*

General Tab — Field Attributes

FIELD NAME

Programmatic identifier (e.g., *emno*). Must match a valid domain name in the package namespace.

COMBINED FIELD

When checked, the field is a composite of two or more normal fields — usable for multi-part indexes and cross-table references.

MANDATORY INPUT

Forces the user to provide a value. Takes precedence over domain range rules when the domain allows zero or empty.

REPEATING FIELD

The field appears multiple times in the table with the same characteristics. Set *No. of Elements* to define the array depth (e.g., 4 keyword levels).

INITIAL VALUE

Pre-populated when a user creates a new record. Defaults to empty string or zero depending on the domain's data type.

RELATED LABEL

Links to an existing label record when *Label Description* is empty — enables label reuse across multiple table fields.

Reference Tab — Referential Integrity Modes

MODE	DELETE BEHAVIOUR	COUNTER?	PERFORMANCE
`Restricted (with counter)`	Blocks delete if child records exist. Reference counter is incremented/decremented on each child insert/delete — checked on parent delete.	✅ Yes	Fastest
`Lookup (Restricted)`	Blocks delete if children exist. Issues a live DB query against the child table on each delete attempt to verify absence of children.	❌ No	Moderate
`Nullifies`	Sets child foreign key to null/empty on parent delete. Rarely used — often violates business rules (e.g., empty	❌ No	Rarely used

MODE	DELETE BEHAVIOUR	COUNTER?	PERFORMANCE
	item codes on purchase orders).		

⚠ **Avoid Duplicate Indexes**

Duplicate indexes in tables with high insert/delete cycles cause severe performance degradation in LN. Always append the primary key to the end of any logically duplicate index to enforce uniqueness without creating a true duplicate.

CHAPTER THREE

RTDD Conversion & Table Creation

From application-level metadata to a live, queryable database table

> *Defining a table in the session layer is only half the job. The metadata must be converted to the runtime file system — and then physically created in the database — before any LN program can access it.*

Step 3 · Convert to Runtime Data Dictionary

After creating or modifying a table definition, it exists only at application level. It must be converted to the **Runtime Data Dictionary (RTDD)** — OS file-level representations that the LN runtime reads at startup.

RTDD Output Path — FILE SYSTEM

```
-- RTDD output directories (both paths are valid)
${BSE}/dict/           -- Modern standard path
${BSE}/../dict/        -- Traditional / legacy path

-- Example: table 900 definition file for package combination b61ctrdv
C:\erpln\dict\ddb61ctrdv\dtdpur\dtdpur900
```

Error 512 — RTDD Sync Mismatch
If the database table is out of sync with its RTDD file (e.g., a field was added in the definition session but RTDD was not re-converted), LN throws
Error 512
on every access. Always re-run RTDD conversion after any structural change to a table definition.

Run session **ttadv5215m000** — set the selection range to your package combination and table, check both *Domains* and *Tables*, enable *Print Errors*, then click **Convert**.

Step 4 · Logout and Re-login

After RTDD conversion, fully log out of the LN application and log back in. This flushes the session cache, forcing LN to reload all runtime objects from the newly converted files. Skipping this step causes the Create Tables session to work against stale dictionary data.

Step 5 · Create the Physical Table

Run session **ttaad4230m000**. Enter the company number, package combination, and target table code in the selection range, then click **Create**. A confirmation dialog — *"1 table(s) created"* — confirms the physical table now exists in the database.

✓ **Batch Creation Across Multiple Companies**
The Create Tables session supports a company range input — you can create the same table across all companies sharing the same package combination in a single run, which is especially useful in multi-company LN environments.

🔍 **Verify with General Table Display (GTD)**
After creation, open session
ttaad4500
and confirm the correct Package, Module, Table, Description, and Company are shown. The GTD is the authoritative way to confirm a table is live and accessible in the LN runtime.

REFERENCE

Quick Reference & Best Practices

Key sessions, paths, and developer habits at a glance

⌘ Session Reference

SESSION	PURPOSE	STEP
`ttadv4120s000`	Table Definitions — create & maintain table metadata structure	1 & 2
`ttadv5215m000`	Convert to Runtime Data Dictionary — publish metadata to OS file level	3
`ttaad4230m000`	Create Tables — physically creates the table in the database	5
`ttaad4500`	General Table Display (GTD) — verify the created table is live	Post-creation
`ttadv4523m000`	Child Fields by Combined Field — manage combined field child structure	When needed

★ Developer Best Practices

✓ **Always re-convert RTDD after any structural change**
Adding, removing, or modifying fields or indexes requires a fresh RTDD conversion. Skipping this causes Error 512 at runtime — every time.

✓ **Never create duplicate indexes**
Append the primary key to the end of any logically duplicate index instead. This ensures uniqueness and avoids severe performance degradation on insert/delete-heavy tables.

✓ **Use custom table number ranges (900+)**
Custom ranges avoid collisions with standard LN table numbers during software updates. Document all custom table numbers in your organisation's change register.

✓ **Prefer Restricted (with counter) for referential integrity**
Counter-based restriction is faster than Lookup Restricted as it avoids live child-table queries on every delete. Use Lookup only when counter maintenance is architecturally infeasible.

✓ **Always logout and re-login after RTDD conversion**

The LN session cache must be fully refreshed before running Create Tables. Without this step, the session works with stale dictionary data and table creation will fail silently.

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> *"A well-designed table definition is the foundation of reliable enterprise data. Take the time to define it right — fields, references, indexes, and all."*

TOPICS COVERED IN THIS GUIDE

- Table Definitions
- Navigation Path
- Field Attributes
- Combined Fields
- Mandatory Input
- Repeating Fields
- Domain Binding
- Referential Integrity
- Delete Modes
- Index Design
- RTDD Conversion
- ttadv5215m000
- ttaad4230m000
- Error 512 Fix
- General Table Display
- Multi-Company Creation